
Hips and Hip Flexors

Companion Workbook — fill it in as you go

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

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HEALING HANDS BY NATE

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Continuity Member Edition — Month 9 Workbook

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Introduction

A PRINTABLE COMPANION TO THE MONTH 9
module. Fill it in as you go.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

PRINT IT. KEEP IT WHERE YOU'LL DO THE WORK — bedroom floor, living room rug, wherever you'll actually stretch.

The hips are slow-changing but durable. Once you make progress, it sticks — unlike the mid-back or jaw, which need ongoing attention to hold. This workbook is built to help you notice the changes as they happen and connect them to the downstream stuff that's been bothering you.

Bring it to your next session.

CHAPTER 2

Where You Are Today

DO THESE THREE QUICK TESTS BEFORE STARTING anything.

Test 1 — Hip flexor length. Lie flat on your back on the floor. Pull your right knee to your chest. While holding the right knee, let your left leg lie flat on the floor.

Does your left leg stay flat? Or does it lift off the floor when you pull the right knee in?

- ☐ Stays flat against the floor (good hip flexor length)
- ☐ Lifts slightly (some tightness)
- ☐ Lifts noticeably (significant tightness)
- ☐ Can't even pull the right knee fully to chest (severe tightness)

Switch sides and check the right hip flexor:

- ☐ Stays flat / ☐ Lifts slightly / ☐ Lifts noticeably / ☐ Can't fully bend

Test 2 — Couch stretch reaction. Try the couch stretch from the module. After 30 seconds, rate:

- Right side intensity (0-10): [____]
- Left side intensity (0-10): [____]

Test 3 — 90-90 position. Can you get into the 90-90 sit?

- ☐ Yes, comfortably
- ☐ Yes, but it's tight
- ☐ Sort of — need to sit on a pillow
- ☐ Can't — I tip backward or it's painful

Rate each symptom (0 = none, 10 = severe):

Low back tightness when standing up after sitting

[_____]

Knee pain or stiffness

[_____]

"Stiff" feeling first thing in the morning

[_____]

Trouble sitting cross-legged

[_____]

Walking gait feels

"stiff" [_____]

Hip pain in the front when lifting your knee

[_____]

CHAPTER 3

Reflection Prompts

PROMPT 1: HOW MANY HOURS DO YOU SIT ON A typical day? Be honest — count work, meals, driving, evening relaxation. What's the actual number?

Prompt 2: What problem have you been blaming on your back, your knees, or your “age” that might actually be a hip flexor problem upstream?

Prompt 3: The psoas is also a stress muscle — it tightens with emotional load. Where in your hips do you carry stress? Have you ever noticed your hips loosen when life calms down, or tighten when it doesn't?

CHAPTER 4

7-Day Hip Reset Tracker

FOR THE NEXT WEEK, DO THE 10-MINUTE DAILY routine and check in below.

Check pattern

- Did I do today's 10-minute hip reset? (Y/N)
 - Couch stretch intensity today (0-10): right ___ / left ___
 - Low back this morning (0 = no problem, 10 = severe): [___]
 - One word for how my hips feel after the reset:
-

Day 1 — Date: _____

10-min reset done? [] / **Couch stretch:** R[] L[]

Low back this morning (0-10): [] / **Hips after reset (one word):** _____

Day 2 — Date: _____

10-min reset done? [] / **Couch stretch:** R[] L[]

Low back this morning (0-10): [] / **Hips after reset (one word):** ____

Day 3 — Date: _____

10-min reset done? [] / **Couch stretch:** R[] L[]

Low back this morning (0-10): [] / **Hips after reset (one word):** ____

Day 4 — Date: _____

10-min reset done? [] / **Couch stretch:** R[] L[]

Low back this morning (0-10): [] / **Hips after reset (one word):** ____

Day 5 — Date: _____

10-min reset done? [] / **Couch stretch:** R[] L[]

Low back this morning (0-10): [] / **Hips after reset (one word):** ____

Day 6 — Date: _____

10-min reset done? [] / **Couch stretch:** R[] L[]

Low back this morning (0-10): [] / **Hips after reset (one word):** ____

Day 7 — Date: _____

10-min reset done? [] / **Couch stretch:** R[] L[]

Low back this morning (0-10): [] / **Hips after reset (one word):** ____

CHAPTER 5

End-of-Week Reflection

RE-DO ALL THREE TESTS FROM THE BEGINNING.

Test 1 — Hip flexor length. Right side: [] flat / [] slight lift / [] noticeable lift. (Day 1: _). **Left side:** [] flat / [] slight lift / [] noticeable lift. (Day 1: _)

Test 2 — Couch stretch intensity (0-10): Right [] (Day 1: []) / Left [] (Day 1: [])

Test 3 — 90-90 position: [] easier / [] same / [] no change

Re-rate each symptom (0-10):

Low back tightness when standing

[] (Day 1: [])

Knee pain or stiffness

[] (Day 1: [])

Morning stiffness

[] (Day 1: [])

Walking gait

[] (Day 1: [])

What changed?

Did the glute bridges start firing in your glutes (not hamstrings)? [Yes / No / Sometimes]

Which move worked best for your body?

- [] Couch stretch
- [] Hip circles
- [] 90-90 hip position
- [] Glute bridges

One commitment for next week:

I will

CHAPTER 6

Try this for 7 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK, try this:

Couch stretch. 30 seconds each side. Twice a day. Every day for one week.

That's the assignment. Two minutes a day, total.

If your low back has been bothering you for years and you do this for seven days, you'll feel a difference. If you don't, message me and we'll figure out what else is going on.

Bring this workbook to your next session.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
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Nate.